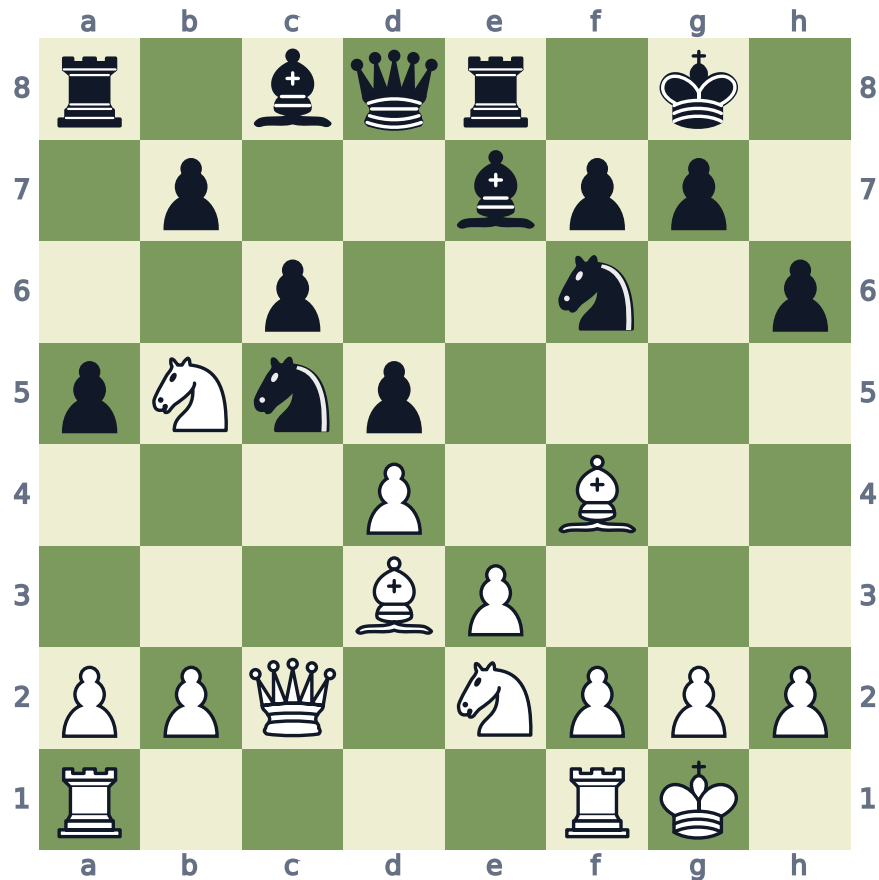


1.d4 Model Games and Guess-the-Move Training

Complete strategic stories generated from the repertoire positions



Practice choosing moves through complete games, with prediction pauses, engine comparisons, and reusable opening-to-middlegame plans.

12 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Practice choosing moves through complete games, with prediction pauses, engine comparisons, and reusable opening-to-middlegame plans.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 12 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Model games connect memorized moves to later plans.

PRINCIPLE 2

Predict before reading to turn examples into training.

PRINCIPLE 3

The opponent's best reply matters more than a cooperative line.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Mark the first move you no longer understood.

PRINCIPLE 5

Extract one reusable plan and one tactical warning from every game.

PRINCIPLE 6

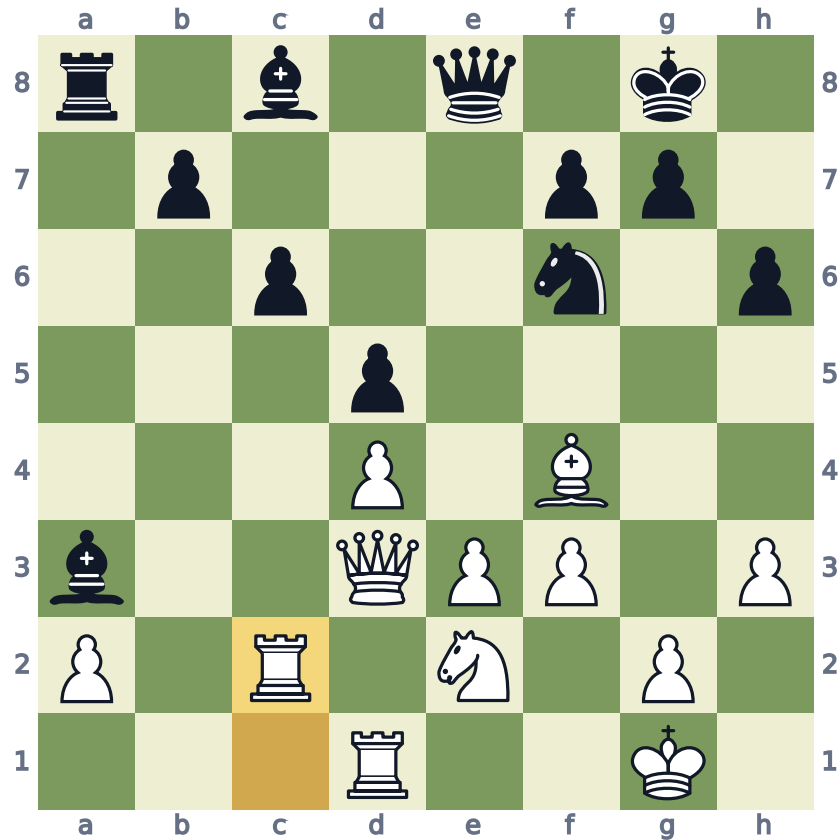
Replay important games from both sides.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

MODEL GAME 01 OF 12

Exchange QGD core



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Bg5 Be7 6. e3 O-O 7. Bd3 Nbd7 8. Qc2 Re8 9. Nge2 c6 10. O-O h6 11. Bf4 a5 12. Nb5 Nc5 13. Nc7 Nxd3 14. Qxd3 Ra7 15. Nxe8 Qxe8 16. Rac1 Bf8 17. Rfe1 Ra8 18. f3 a4 19. h3 Bb4 20. Red1 a3 21. bxa3 Bxa3 22. Rc2

STRATEGIC STORY

Build toward f3 and e4 or a queenside minority attack.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

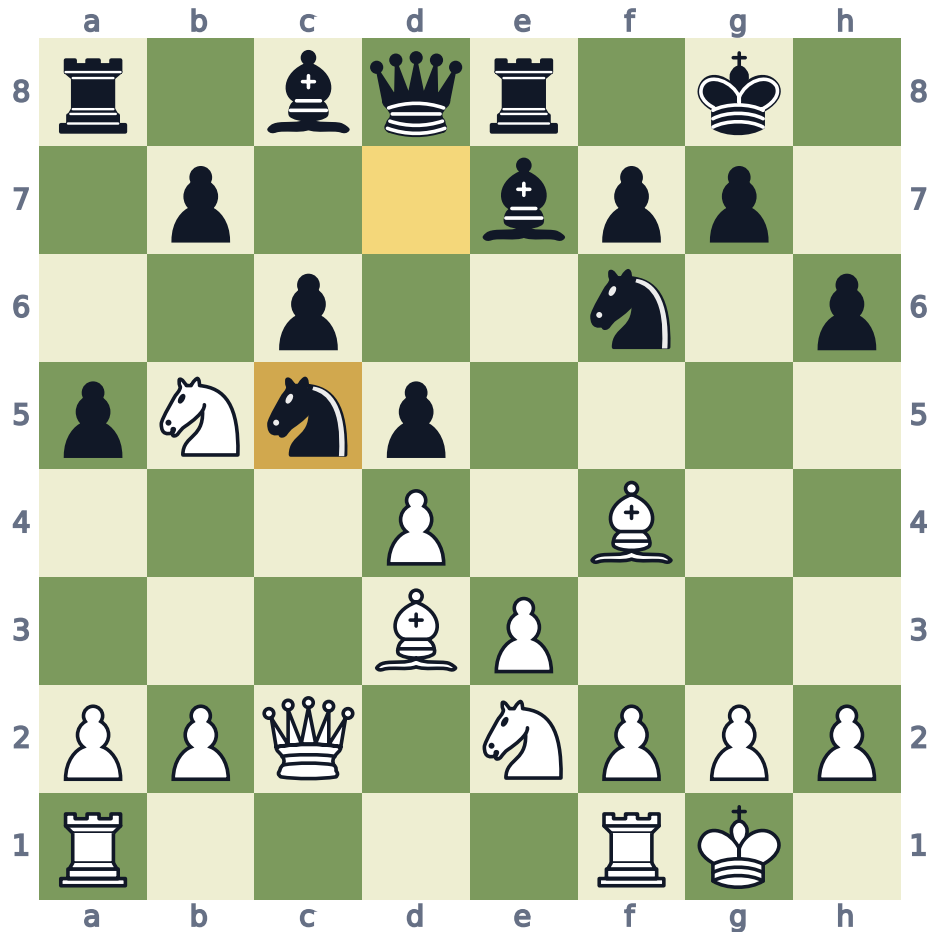
Do not play e4 until d4 and the king are secure.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 01

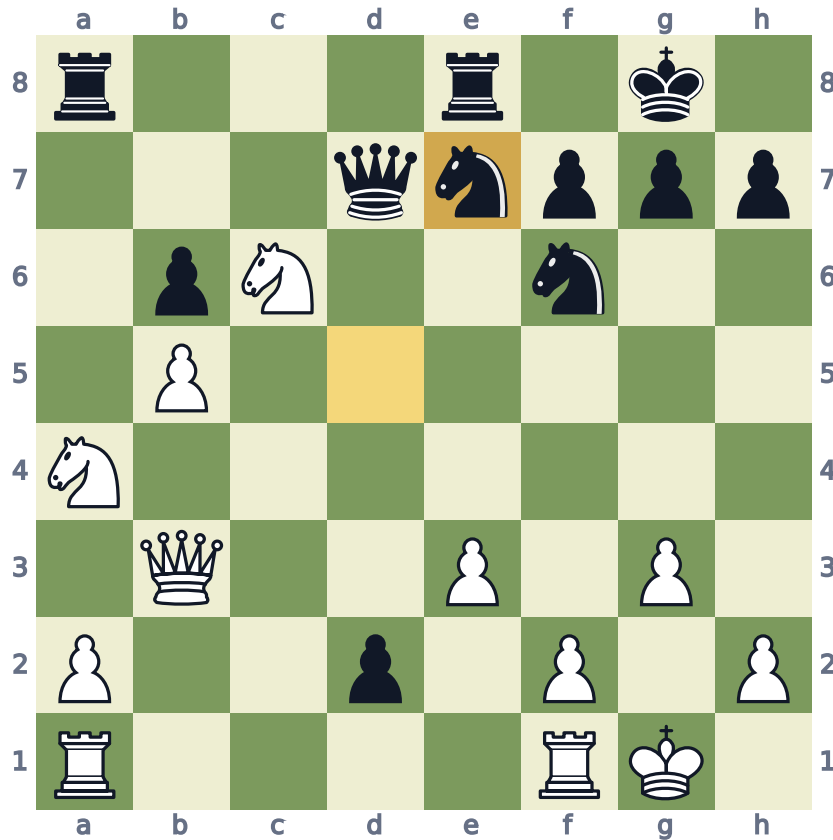
Exchange QGD core

**PREDICTION TASK**

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 02 OF 12

Tarrasch Defense



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c5 4. cxd5 exd5 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. g3 Nf6 7. Bg2 Be7 8. O-O O-O 9. dxc5 d4 10. Na4 Bf5 11. b4 d3 12. e3 b5 13. cxb6 axb6 14. b5 Nb4 15. Nd4 Be4 16. Ba3 Bxg2 17. Kxg2 Re8 18. Kg1 d2 19. Qb3 Nbd5 20. Nc6 Qd7 21. Bxe7 Nxe7

STRATEGIC STORY

Pressure the isolated d5-pawn while finishing development.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

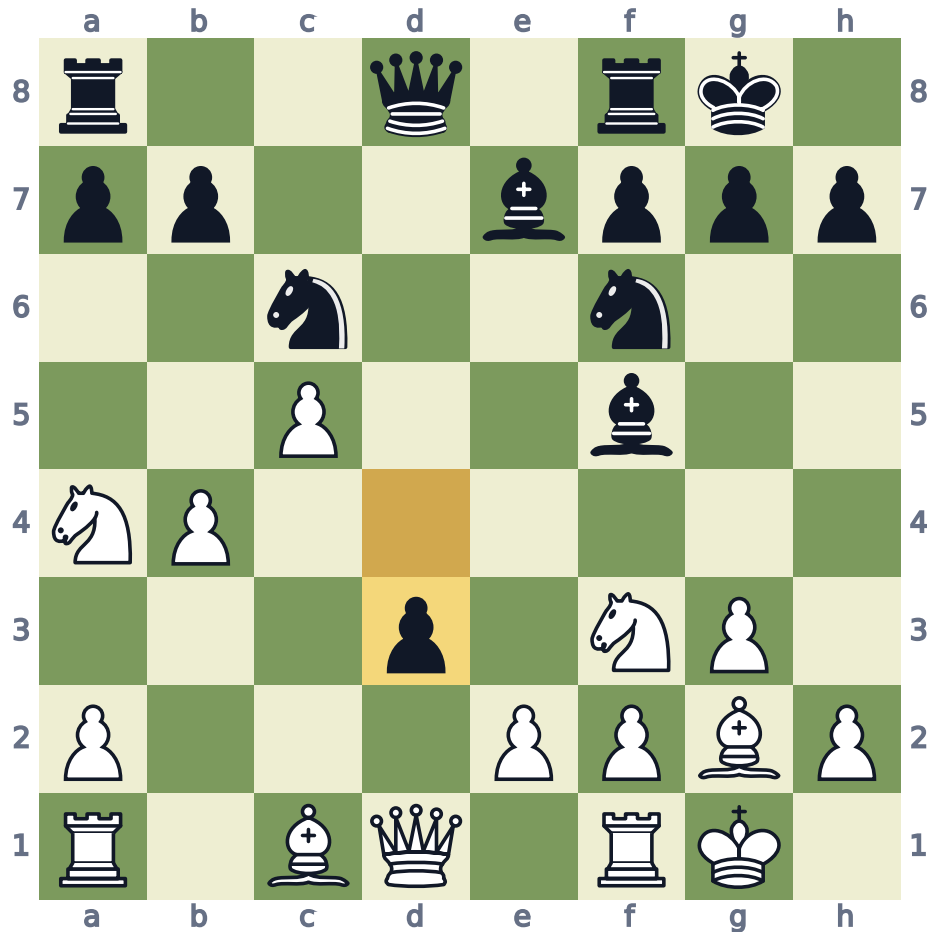
Passive blockade lets Black use active piece play as compensation.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 02

Tarrasch Defense

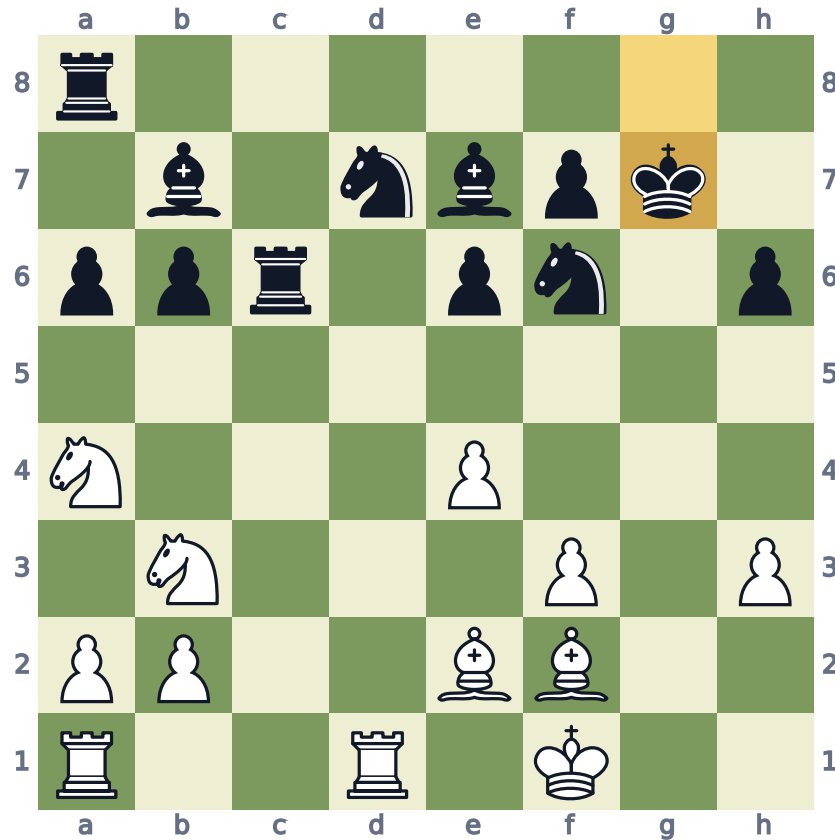


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 03 OF 12

QGA classical recovery



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 dxc4 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bxc4 c5 6. O-O a6 7. dxc5 Qxd1 8. Rxd1 Bxc5 9. Be2 Nbd7 10. Nd4 O-O 11. Nb3 Be7 12. Bd2 b6 13. f3 Bb7 14. e4 Rfc8 15. Be3 Rc7 16. Nc3 h6 17. Na4 Rc6 18. Kf1 g5 19. h4 gxh4 20. Bf2 h3 21. gxh3 Kg7

STRATEGIC STORY

Recover c4 through development and accept a clean active endgame.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

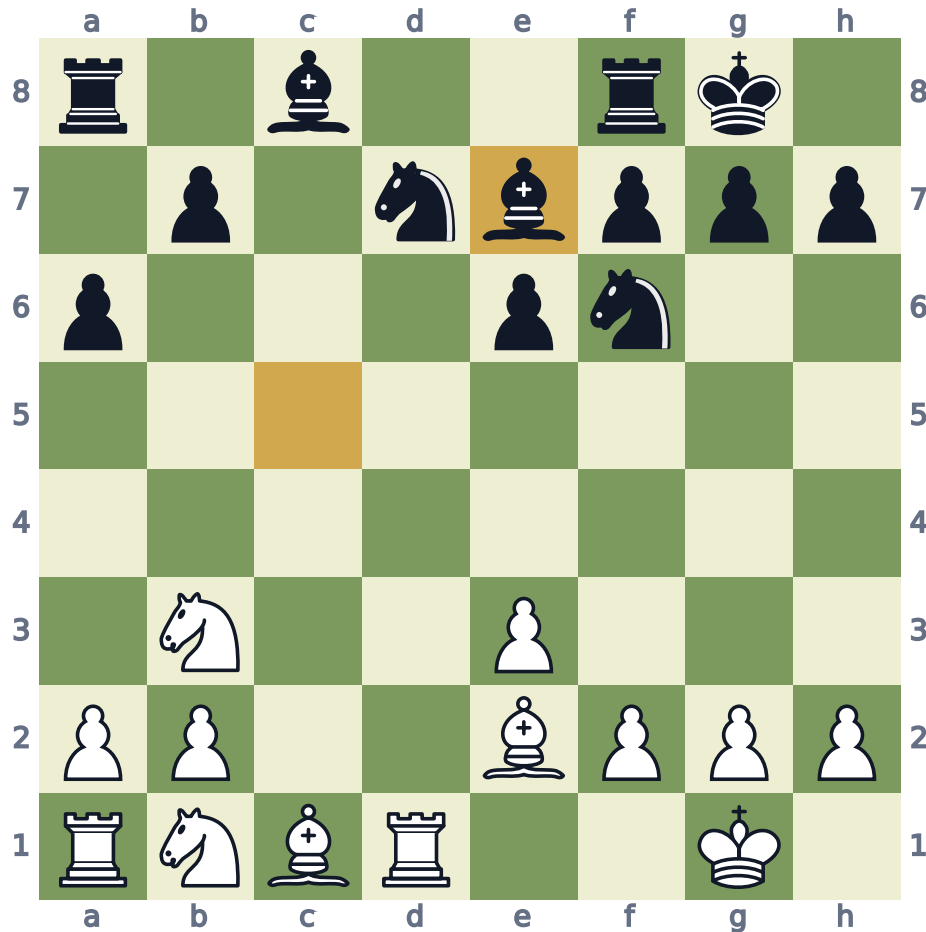
Do not fear queen trades when development and structure are healthy.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 03

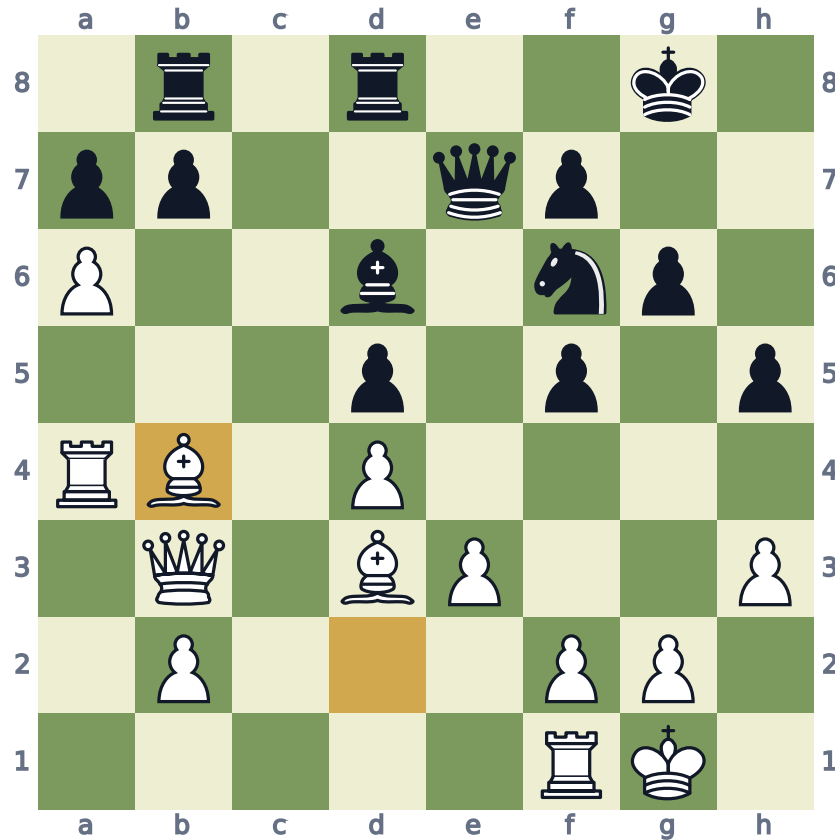
QGA classical recovery

**PREDICTION TASK**

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 04 OF 12

Main Slav recovery



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bf5 6. e3 e6 7. Bxc4 Bb4 8. O-O Nbd7 9. Nh4 O-O 10. Nxf5 exf5 11. Qc2 Nb6 12. Be2 Qd7 13. a5 Nbd5 14. Qb3 Bd6 15. Nxd5 cxd5 16. h3 Qe7 17. Bd2 h5 18. Ra4 Rfd8 19. Bd3 g6 20. a6 Rab8 21. Bb4

STRATEGIC STORY

Limit ...b5, recover c4, and castle before central expansion.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

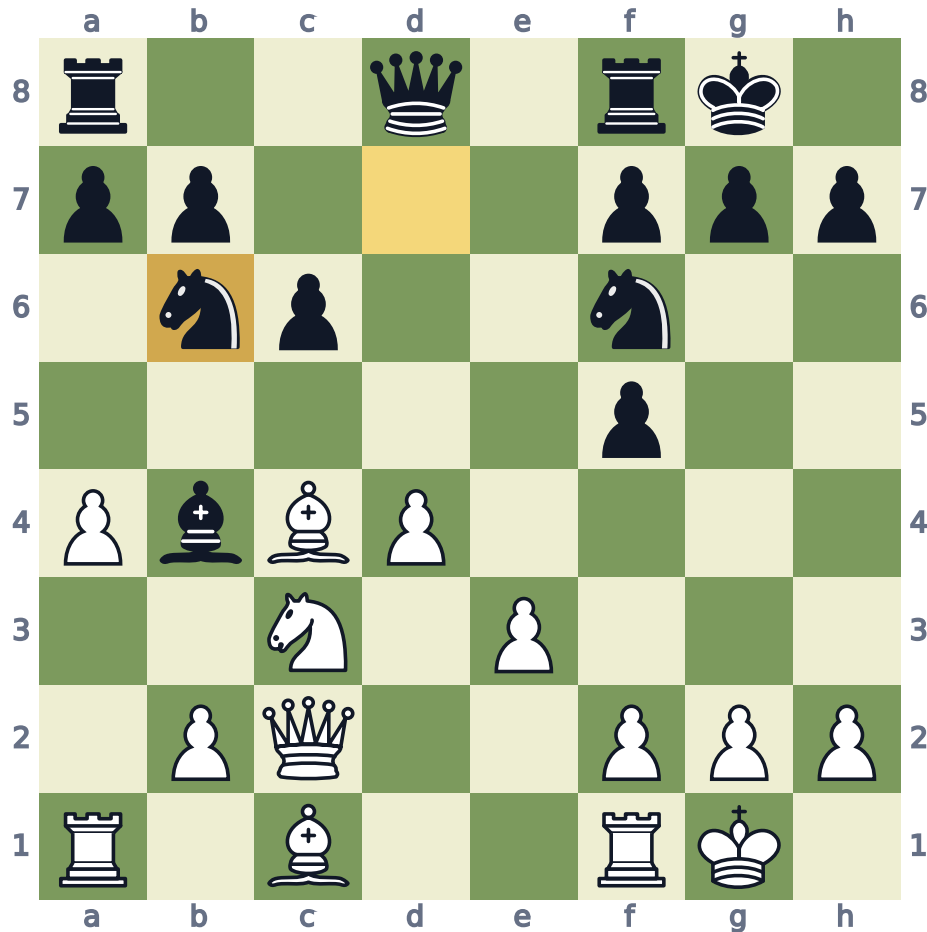
e4 can be met by ...b5 or ...Bb4 if played too early.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 04

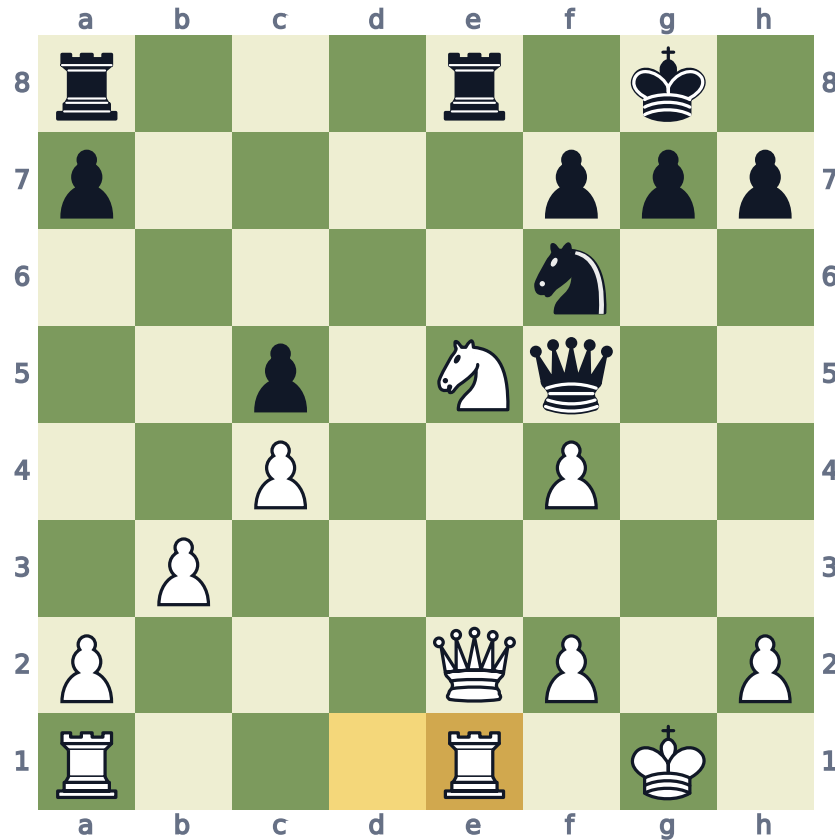
Main Slav recovery

**PREDICTION TASK**

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 05 OF 12

Closed Catalan core



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Qc2 c6 8. Nbd2 b6 9. e4 dxe4 10. Nxe4 Nxe4 11. Qxe4 Bb7 12. Bf4 Nf6 13. Qe2 Qc8 14. Rfd1 Re8 15. Ne5 c5 16. Bf3 Bd6 17. dxc5 Bxf3 18. Nxf3 Bxf4 19. gxf4 e5 20. Nxe5 bxc5 21. b3 Qf5 22. Re1

STRATEGIC STORY

Complete the fianchetto and prepare e4 while the center remains closed.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

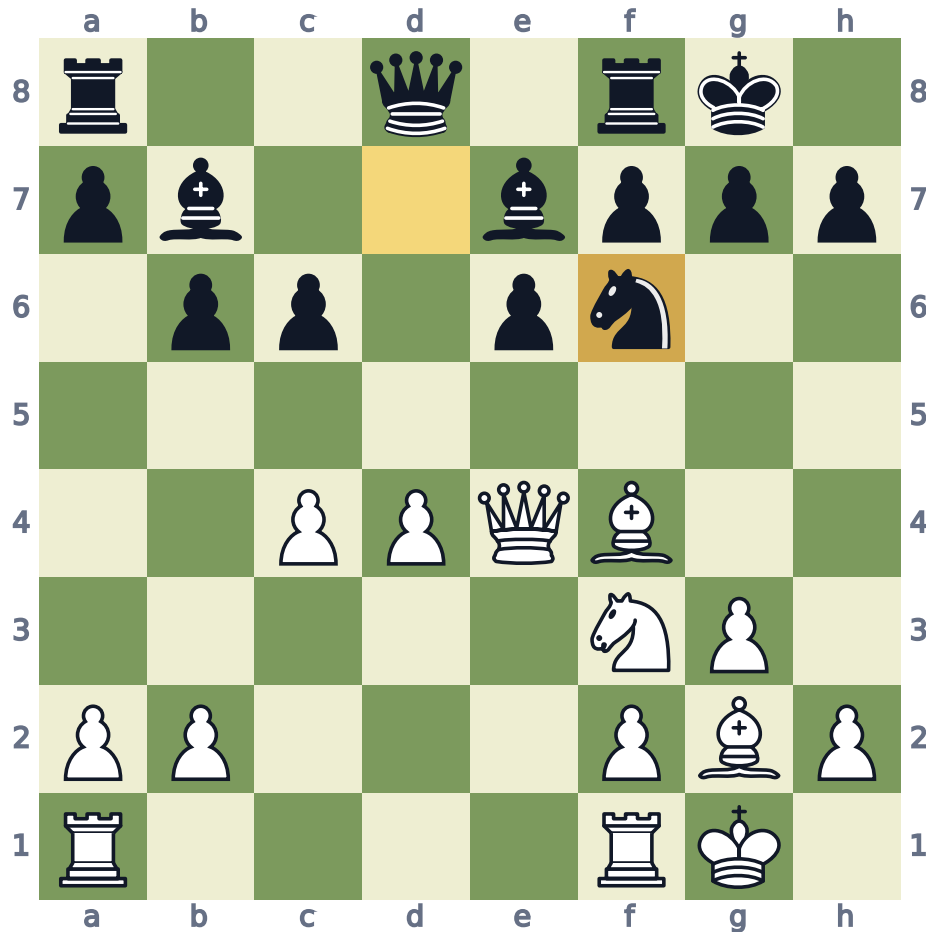
e4 without enough support can lose d4 or permit ...dxe4.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 05

Closed Catalan core

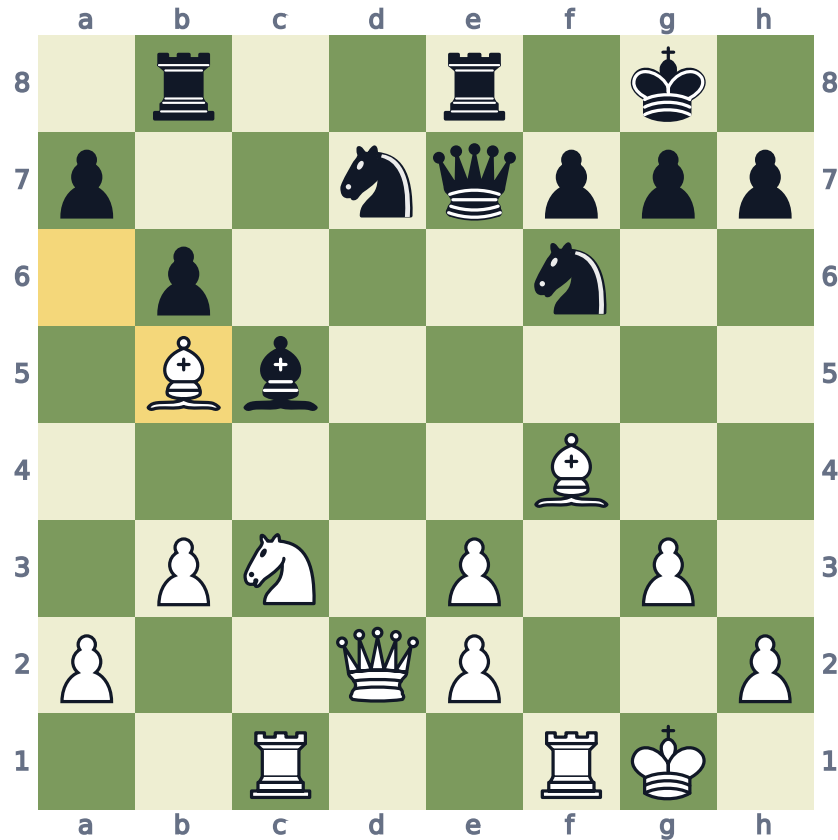


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 06 OF 12

Queen's Indian ...Ba6



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Be7 7. Bg2 O-O 8. O-O d5 9. cxd5 exd5 10. Nc3 Nbd7 11. Bf4 Re8 12. Ne5 Bb7 13. Rc1 c5 14. Nc4 Rc8 15. Ne3 cxd4 16. Qxd4 Bc5 17. Qd2 d4 18. Bxb7 dxe3 19. fxe3 Rb8 20. Ba6 Qe7 21. Bb5

STRATEGIC STORY

Use b3 to protect c4 and force the bishop to declare its purpose.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

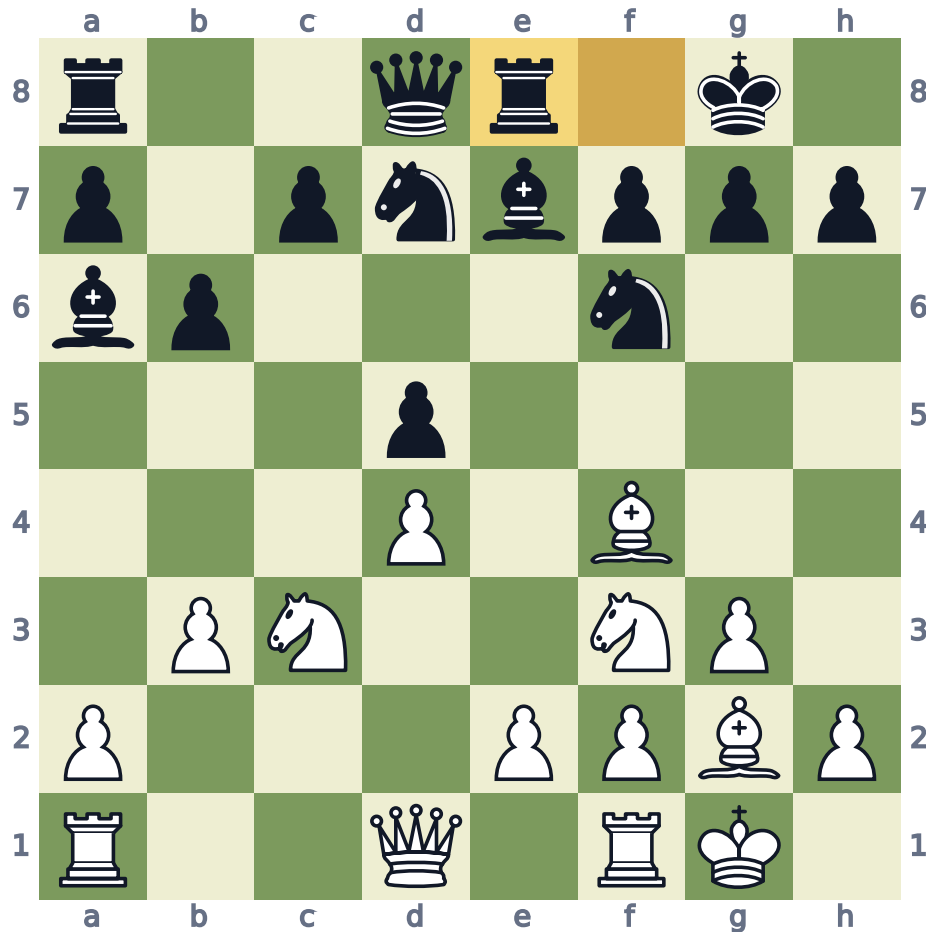
b3 weakens dark squares if White later loses the g2 bishop.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

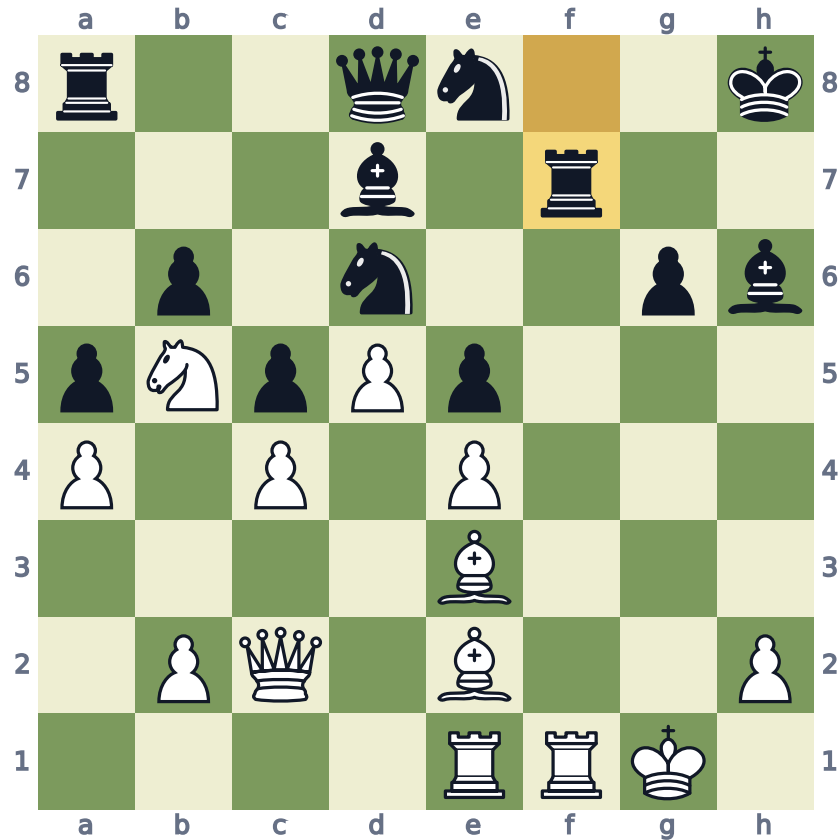
GUESS THE MOVE 06

Queen's Indian ...Ba6



MODEL GAME 07 OF 12

Classical King's Indian



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Be3 b6 10. Nd2 c5 11. a4 a5 12. Nb5 h6 13. f4 Ne8 14. fxe5 dxe5 15. Qc2 Kh8 16. Nf3 Bd7 17. Rae1 Nc8 18. g4 Ncd6 19. g5 hxg5 20. Nxg5 Bh6 21. Nxf7+ Rxf7

STRATEGIC STORY

Close the center and prepare queenside expansion while tracking ...f5.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

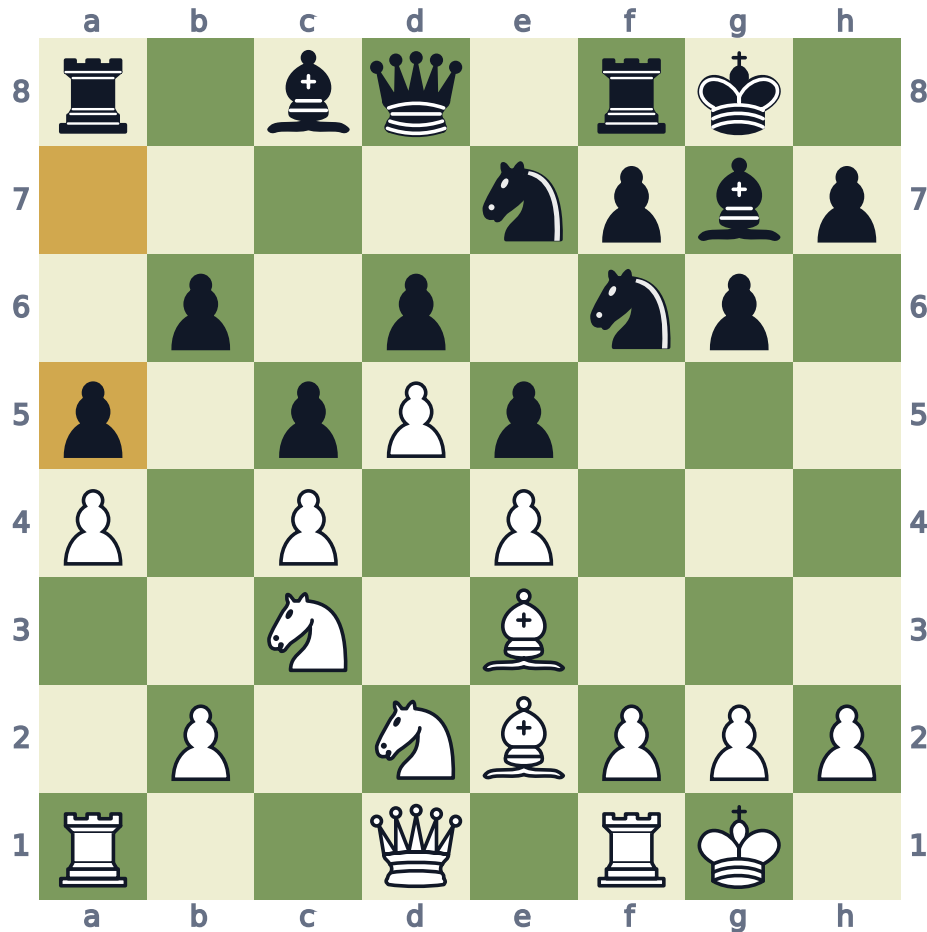
The kingside can open rapidly after ...f5 and ...fxe4.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 07

Classical King's Indian

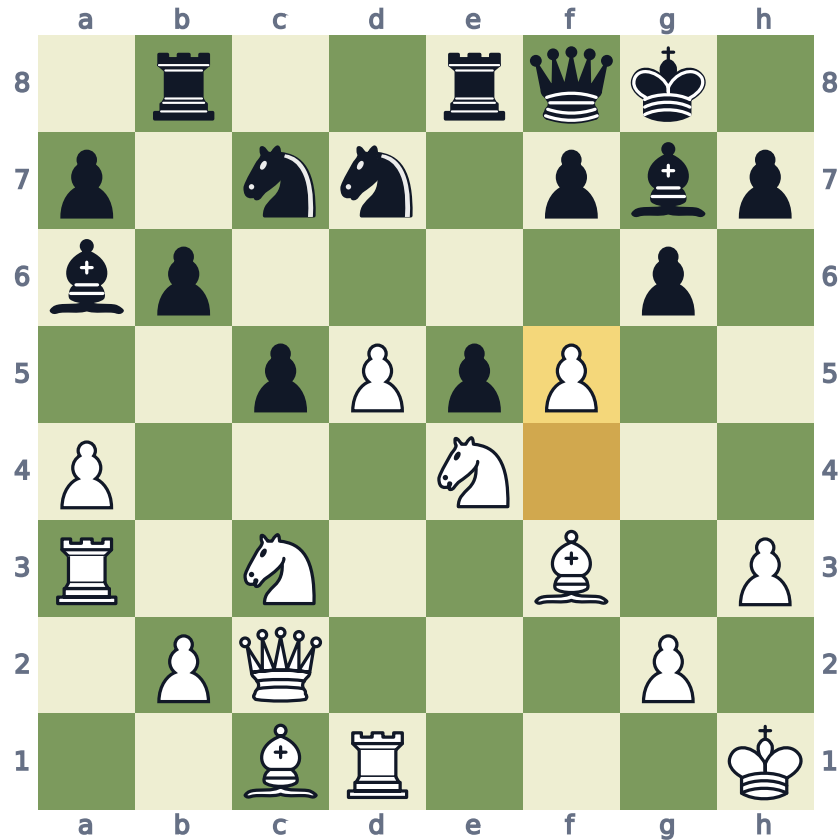


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 08 OF 12

KID ...c5



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. O-O exd5 9. cxd5 Re8 10. Nd2 Na6 11. f3 Nc7 12. Kh1 Nh5 13. f4 Nf6 14. a4 b6 15. h3 Rb8 16. Bf3 Bb7 17. Qc2 Ba6 18. Rd1 Qe7 19. Ra3 Nd7 20. e5 dxe5 21. Nde4 Qf8 22. f5

STRATEGIC STORY

Recognize the Benoni structure and use space with e4 and queenside play.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

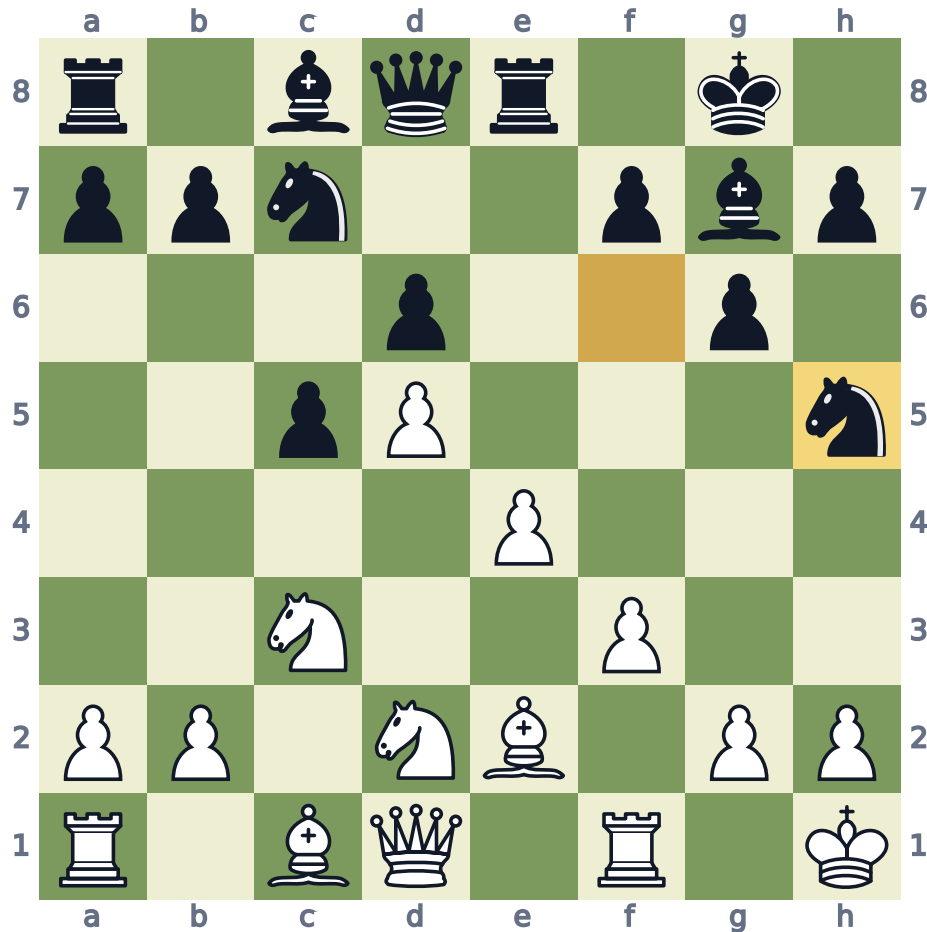
Do not follow a King's Indian plan after the structure has changed.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 08

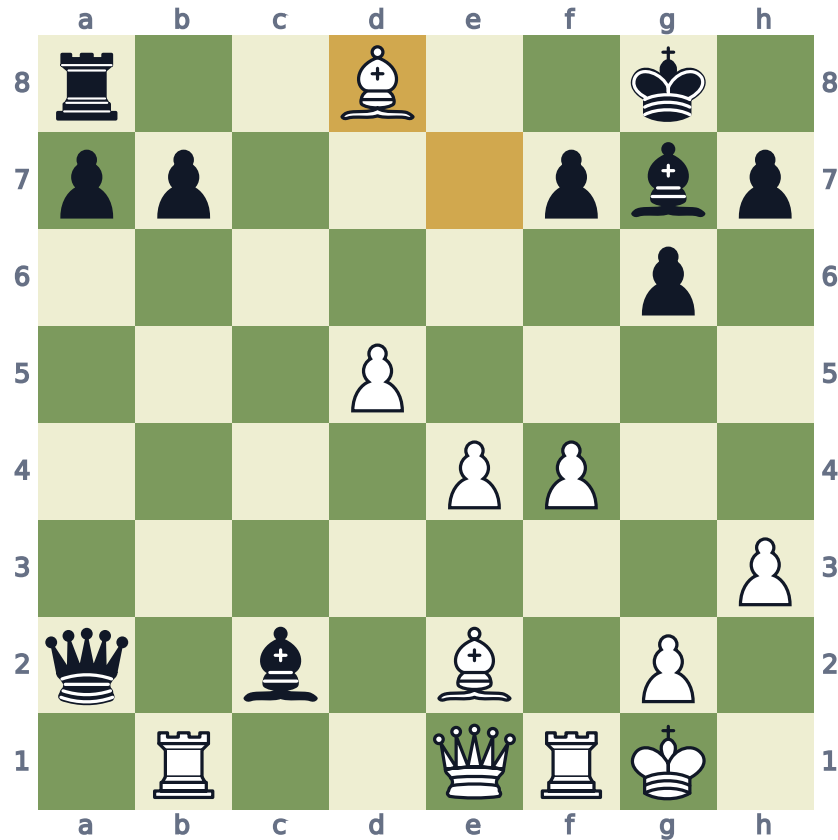
KID ...c5

**PREDICTION TASK**

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 09 OF 12

Exchange Grunfeld core



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 d5 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. e4 Nxc3 6. bxc3 Bg7 7. Nf3 c5 8. Be3 Qa5 9. Bd2 O-O 10. h3 Nc6 11. Be2 cxd4 12. cxd4 Qa3 13. d5 Ne5 14. Nxe5 Bxe5 15. Rb1 Qxa2 16. O-O Rd8 17. f4 Bg7 18. Bb4 Bd7 19. Bxe7 Ba4 20. Qe1 Bc2 21. Bxd8

STRATEGIC STORY

Build the center, develop with tempo, and protect d4.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

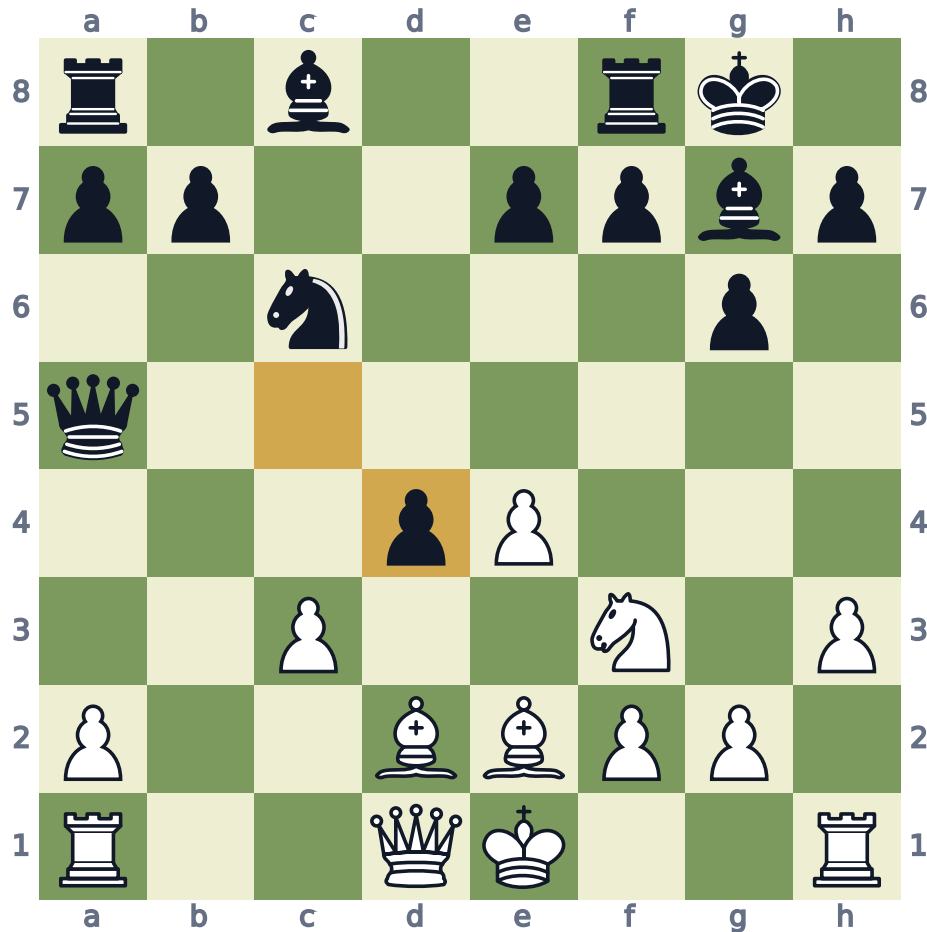
The c3 pawn and d4 base can become targets on the long diagonal.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 09

Exchange Grunfeld core

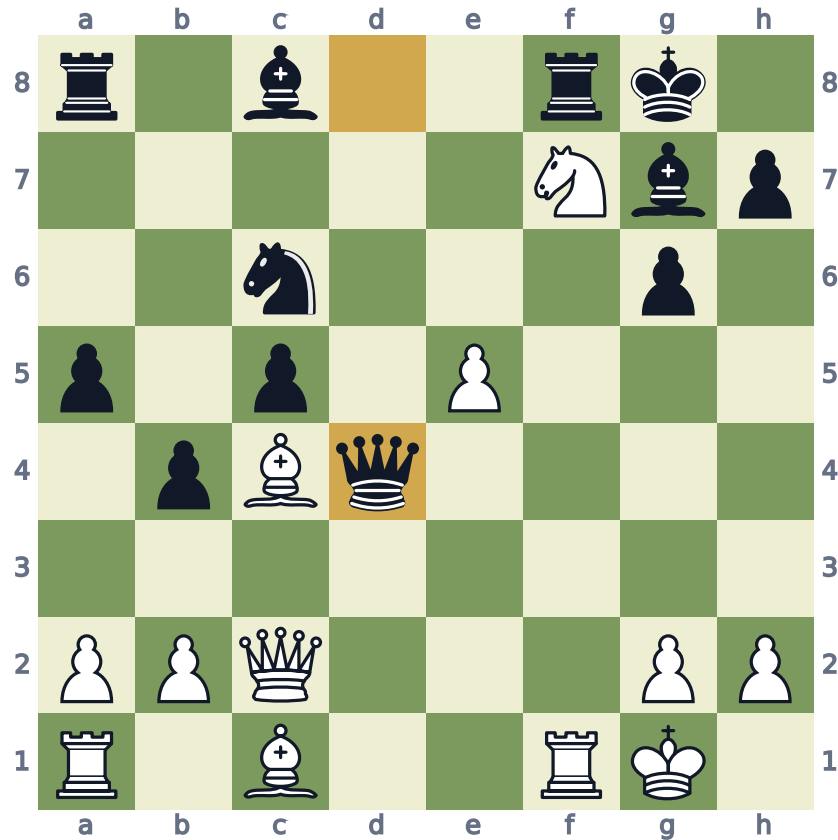


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 10 OF 12

Modern Benoni core



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 e6 4. Nc3 exd5 5. cxd5 d6 6. e4 g6 7. f4 Bg7 8. Bb5+ Nfd7 9. Nf3 a6 10. Be2 b5 11. O-O O-O 12. Qc2 b4 13. Nd1 Nf6 14. Ne3 a5 15. e5 dxe5 16. fxe5 Nxd5 17. Nxd5 Qxd5 18. Bc4 Qd8 19. Ng5 Nc6 20. Nxf7 Qd4+

STRATEGIC STORY

Use e4-f4 and prepare e5 while Black seeks queenside counterplay.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

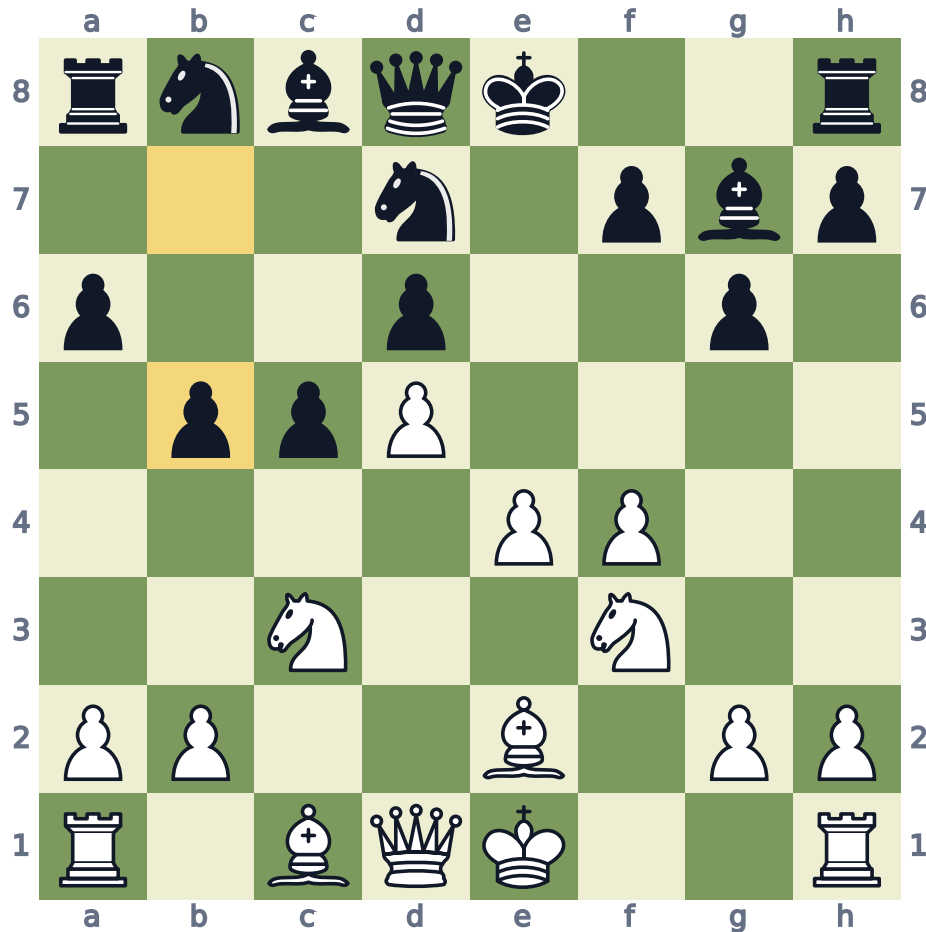
The center can be attacked by ...Re8, ...b5, and tactics on e4.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 10

Modern Benoni core

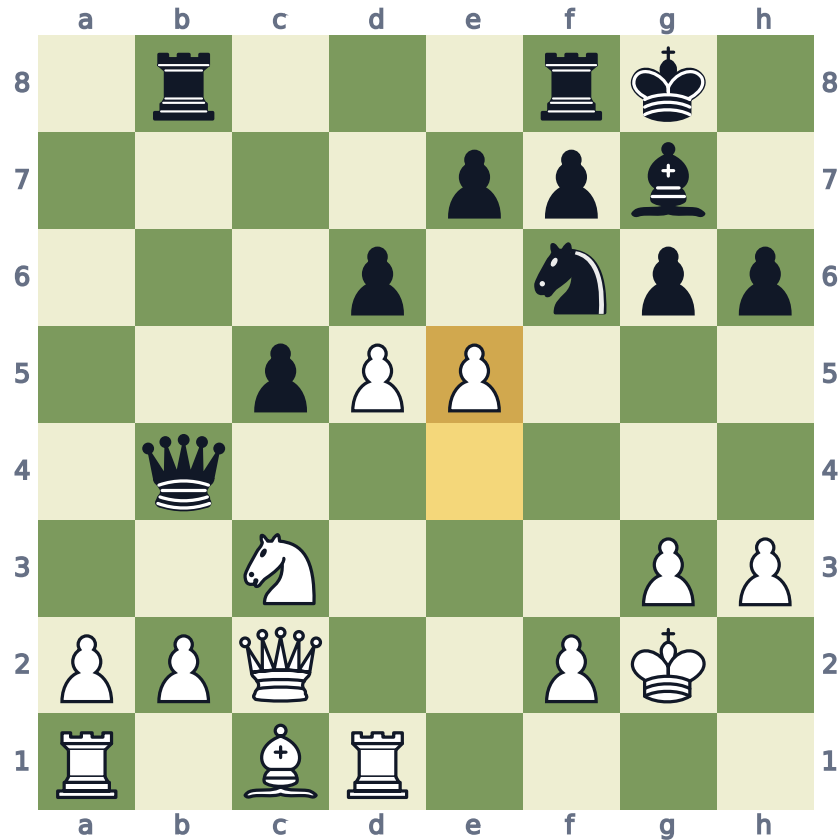


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 11 OF 12

Benko accepted



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 c5 3. d5 b5 4. cxb5 a6 5. bxa6 Bxa6 6. Nc3 d6 7. e4 Bxf1 8. Kxf1 g6 9. Nf3 Qc8 10. Kg1 Bg7 11. g3 Qh3 12. Ng5 Qh5 13. Qb3 Nbd7 14. Kg2 Rb8 15. Qa4 h6 16. Nf3 O-O 17. h3 Ne5 18. Nxe5 Qxe5 19. Qc2 Qd4 20. Rd1 Qb4 21. e5

STRATEGIC STORY

Consolidate the extra pawn while neutralizing files and the g7 bishop.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

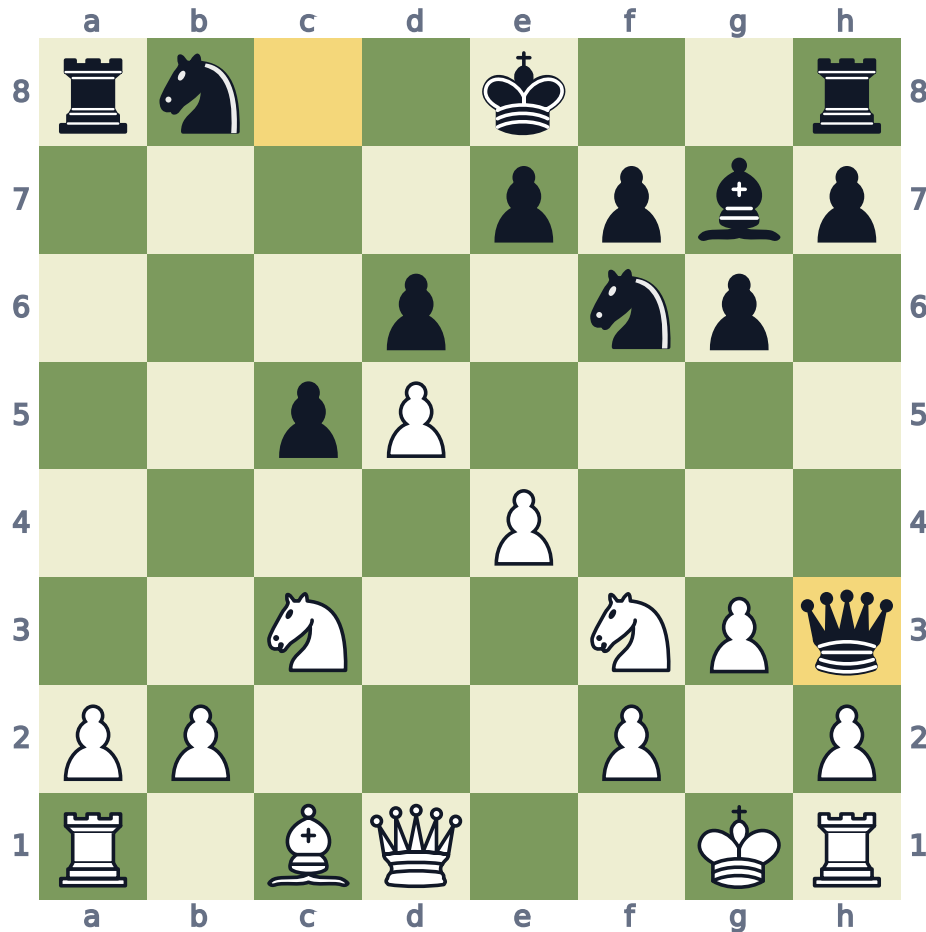
The king and queenside can remain awkward for many moves.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 11

Benko accepted

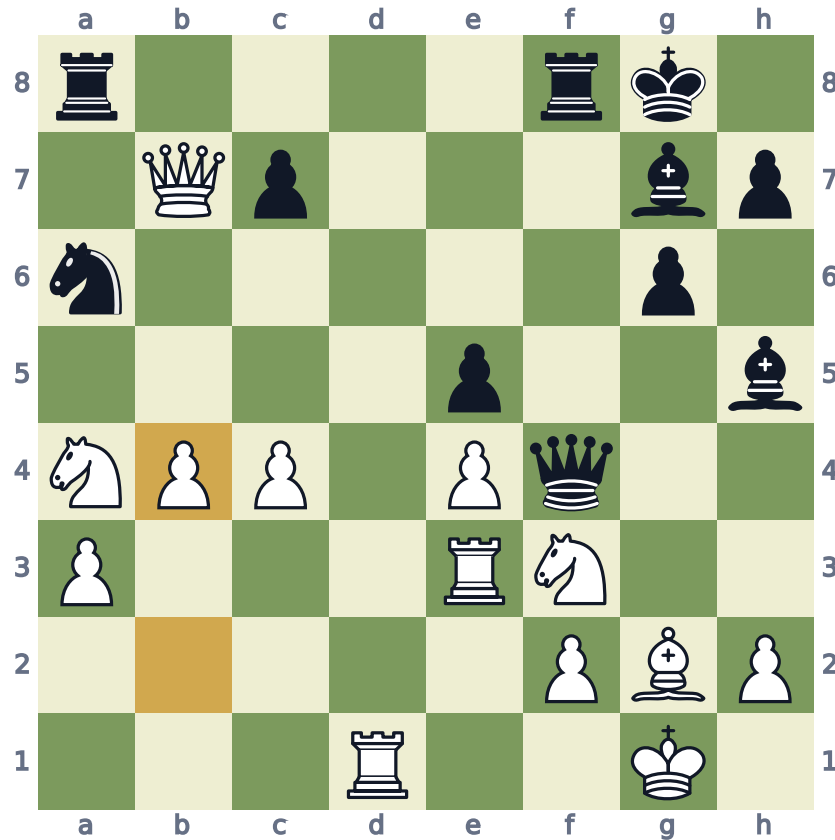


PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

MODEL GAME 12 OF 12

Leningrad Dutch



COMPLETE SCORE

1. d4 f5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 g6 4. Nf3 Bg7 5. O-O O-O 6. c4 d6 7. Nc3 a5 8. Re1 Na6 9. Qb3 Qe8 10. Bg5 a4 11. Nxa4 e5 12. Bxf6 Bxf6 13. e4 f4 14. gxf4 Qf7 15. dxe5 dxe5 16. Rad1 Bg4 17. a3 Bg7 18. Qxb7 Qxf4 19. Re3 Bh5 20. b4

STRATEGIC STORY

Fianchetto, control e4, and prepare d5 or Qc2 depending on ...e5.

DANGER DEMONSTRATED

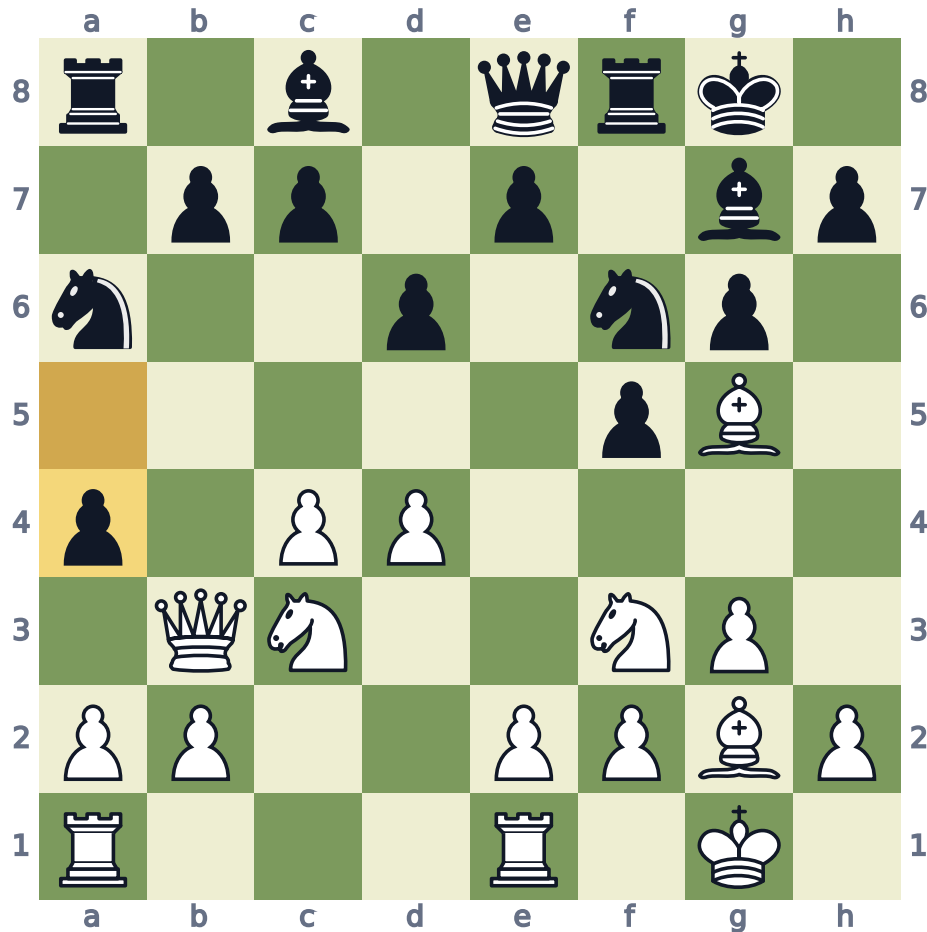
Black's ...e5 can arrive with tactical force against d4.

RESULT

* - constructed engine training game; use it to study plans, not as historical evidence.

GUESS THE MOVE 12

Leningrad Dutch



PREDICTION TASK

White to move. Choose three candidates. Explain the structure, the least active piece, the urgent tactical issue, and the opponent's best reply. Award 3 points for the game move, 2 for a sound engine alternative, 2 for the reply, 2 for the plan, and 1 for notation.

ANSWER SECTION

Model-game predictions

COMPARE DECISIONS, NOT JUST MOVES

The game move is one strong practical choice. Compare it with the engine line and ask whether both moves serve the same plan. If your move was sound but different, note the structural idea that justified it.

SOLUTIONS

Games 1-3

01. EXCHANGE QGD CORE

Game move: Nc7. Engine comparison: 1. Nc7 Nxd3 2. Qxd3 Bd7 3. Nxa8 Qxa8 4. Ng3 b6 5. Rfd1 Bf8 (+1.89 for White (White is clearly better)). Strategic explanation: Build toward f3 and e4 or a queenside minority attack.

02. TARRASCH DEFENSE

Game move: e3. Engine comparison: 1. b5 dxe2 2. Qxe2 Bd3 3. Qb2 Bxf1 4. Bxf1 Na5 5. Bf4 Rc8 (+0.76 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Pressure the isolated d5-pawn while finishing development.

03. QGA CLASSICAL RECOVERY

Game move: Bd2. Engine comparison: 1. Na3 b6 2. Bd2 Bb7 3. Rac1 Rfc8 4. Nc4 a5 5. Nd4 (+0.39 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Recover c4 through development and accept a clean active endgame.

SOLUTIONS

Games 4-6

04. MAIN SLAV RECOVERY

Game move: Be2. Engine comparison: 1. Be2 Qd7 2. a5 Nbd5 3. Qb3 Bd6 4. Bd2 Rab8 5. Nxd5 cxd5 (+0.25 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Limit ...b5, recover c4, and castle before central expansion.

05. CLOSED CATALAN CORE

Game move: Qe2. Engine comparison: 1. Qe2 c5 2. Rfd1 cxd4 3. Rxd4 Qc8 4. Ne5 Bxg2 5. Kxg2 Qb7+ (+0.56 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Complete the fianchetto and prepare e4 while the center remains closed.

06. QUEEN'S INDIAN ...BA6

Game move: Ne5. Engine comparison: 1. Ne5 Bb7 2. Rc1 Nf8 3. Bg5 Ne6 4. Bxf6 Bxf6 5. f4 Rc8 (+0.26 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Use b3 to protect c4 and force the bishop to declare its purpose.

SOLUTIONS

Games 7-9

07. CLASSICAL KING'S INDIAN

Game move: Nb5. Engine comparison: 1. f4 Ne8 2. fxe5 dxe5 3. g4 f5 4. gxf5 gxf5 5. Kh1 Kh8 (+0.78 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Close the center and prepare queenside expansion while tracking ...f5.

08. KID ...C5

Game move: f4. Engine comparison: 1. a4 f5 2. exf5 Qh4 3. Nce4 gxf5 4. f4 Nxf4 5. g3 Qe7 (+0.46 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Recognize the Benoni structure and use space with e4 and queenside play.

09. EXCHANGE GRUNFELD CORE

Game move: cxd4. Engine comparison: 1. cxd4 Qa3 2. d5 Ne5 3. O-O Bd7 4. Rb1 Qxa2 5. Rxb7 Ba4 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Build the center, develop with tempo, and protect d4.

SOLUTIONS

Games 10-12

10. MODERN BENONI CORE

Game move: O-O. Engine comparison: 1. O-O O-O 2. e5 dxe5 3. a4 b4 4. Ne4 exf4 5. Bxf4 Nf6 (+0.12 for White (equal)). Strategic explanation: Use e4-f4 and prepare e5 while Black seeks queenside counterplay.

11. BENKO ACCEPTED

Game move: Ng5. Engine comparison: 1. Ng5 Qh5 2. Qb3 O-O 3. Kg2 Qg4 4. h3 Qc8 5. Nf3 Na6 (+0.46 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Consolidate the extra pawn while neutralizing files and the g7 bishop.

12. LENINGRAD DUTCH

Game move: Nxa4. Engine comparison: 1. Nxa4 e5 2. Bxf6 Rxf6 3. Nc3 c6 4. e3 e4 5. Nd2 Qe7 (+0.66 for White (White is slightly better)). Strategic explanation: Fianchetto, control e4, and prepare d5 or Qc2 depending on ...e5.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.